PrintOnline Ethiopia — Version 3.5 Release Notes

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Executive Summary

Version 3.5 represents a **major milestone** in the evolution of the PrintOnline Ethiopia digital platform. This release introduces **ten significant new features and enhancements** designed to improve the customer experience, streamline order management, provide greater transparency in pricing, and strengthen the communication between our valued customers and the PrintOnline team.

At its core, Version 3.5 is about **empowering customers** with more control, more information, and better tools to manage their printing projects from start to finish. Whether you're ordering business cards, banners, branded apparel, or promotional materials, these updates make the entire process smoother, more transparent, and more efficient.

Key Highlights:

- 📍 **Smart delivery pricing** based on your location in Addis Ababa

- 💬 **Direct messaging** with our team about your orders
- 📊 **Complete order history** with detailed status tracking
- 🎨 **Hire-a-Designer service** now configurable per product
- 🧾 **Persistent payment receipts** that never disappear
- 🔒 **Full account control** including account deletion
- ⚡ **Faster, more stable** platform performance

Version Overview

Release Information

Field	Details
Version Number	3.5.0
Release Date	April 2026
Platform	Web Application (printonline.et)
Supported Browsers	Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge (latest versions)
Supported Devices	Desktop, Tablet, Mobile
API Version	v1 (unchanged)
Database Schema Version	v3.5

Development Timeline

Phase	Description	Status
Phase 1	Core Foundation (Account Deletion, Delivery Pricing)	✅ Complete
Phase 2	Communication System (Messaging Portal)	✅ Complete
Phase 3	Payment & Receipt Enhancements	✅ Complete
Phase 4	Performance Optimization	✅ Complete
Phase 5	Testing & Quality Assurance	✅ Complete

What Changed Since Version 3.0

Version 3.0 introduced the core e-commerce platform with product browsing, cart management, and Chapa payment integration. Version 3.5 builds upon this foundation with significant enhancements to the checkout experience, customer communication tools, order management capabilities, and platform stability.

Major additions since v3.0:

- Location-aware delivery pricing (replacing flat-rate delivery)
- Customer-admin messaging portal (entirely new feature)
- Account deletion capability (new security feature)
- Enhanced receipt management (improved payment experience)

- Quantity-based delivery discounts (new bulk ordering incentive)
- Performance optimizations (improved stability on all platforms)

What's New in Version 3.5

3.1 Location-Based Delivery Pricing

Category: Core E-Commerce Enhancement
Impact Level: High — Affects all customers selecting home delivery
User-Facing Change: Delivery fees now vary based on your delivery address

What Changed

Previously, all deliveries within Addis Ababa were charged a flat delivery fee regardless of the customer's specific location. Starting with Version 3.5, delivery pricing is now calculated based on the **distance between your delivery address and the PrintOnline headquarters** located in Bole Sub City.

How It Works

When you proceed to checkout, the system automatically calculates your delivery fee based on the **sub-city** specified in your delivery address. The fee structure is designed to reflect the actual cost of delivery to your area, ensuring fair and transparent pricing for all customers.

Delivery Fee Structure

The delivery fee is determined by which of Addis Ababa's sub-cities your delivery address falls within. The system uses a tiered pricing model based on the approximate distance from our headquarters:

Zone 1 — Headquarters Area (Bole)

- Delivery Fee: 50 Birr
- Coverage: Bole Sub City and immediate surrounding areas
- Estimated Delivery: Standard timeline

Zone 2 — Near Zone

- Delivery Fee: 60 Birr
- Coverage: Kirkos, Arada
- Estimated Delivery: Standard timeline

Zone 3 — Medium Zone

- Delivery Fee: 70 Birr
- Coverage: Addis Ketema, Gulele, Yeka
- Estimated Delivery: Standard timeline

Zone 4 — Far Zone

- Delivery Fee: 80 Birr
- Coverage: Kolfe Keranio, Nifas Silk-Lafto

- Estimated Delivery: Standard timeline

Zone 5 — Outer Zone

- Delivery Fee: 100 Birr
- Coverage: Akaki-Kality, Lemi Kura
- Estimated Delivery: Standard timeline (may occasionally require additional day for remote areas)

Free Delivery Threshold

Orders with a subtotal of **5,000 Birr or more** qualify for **free delivery** to any location within Addis Ababa. This threshold applies to the order subtotal before delivery fees are added.

Example:

- Order subtotal: 4,500 Birr → Delivery fee applies based on zone
- Order subtotal: 5,000 Birr → Free delivery to any address in Addis Ababa
- Order subtotal: 8,000 Birr → Free delivery to any address in Addis Ababa

Pickup Option

Customers who prefer to collect their orders directly from our workshop can select the **Office Pickup** option during checkout. This option carries **zero delivery fees** and allows you to pick up your completed order at:

PrintOnline Workshop
Pana Promotion PLC
Bole Sub City, Woreda 03
Wakero Building
Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
Phone: +251911005255

You will receive a notification when your order is ready for pickup.

Where You'll See This

- **Checkout page:** Delivery fee displayed in order summary
- **Order confirmation:** Delivery fee shown in payment breakdown
- **Account orders:** Delivery fee visible in order details

3.2 Quantity-Based Delivery Discounts

Category: E-Commerce Enhancement
Impact Level: Medium — Benefits customers ordering in bulk
User-Facing Change: Larger orders receive discounted or free delivery

What Changed

In addition to location-based pricing, Version 3.5 introduces a **quantity-based discount system** for delivery fees. Customers ordering larger quantities of products will benefit from reduced delivery costs, with orders of

51 or more items receiving **completely free delivery** regardless of order value or delivery location.

How It Works

The system calculates the total number of items in your cart and applies the appropriate discount tier to your delivery fee:

Total Items in Order	Delivery Discount	Your Delivery Fee
1–5 items	No discount (standard)	Full zone fee
6–10 items	20% off delivery	80% of zone fee
11–20 items	40% off delivery	60% of zone fee
21–50 items	60% off delivery	40% of zone fee
51+ items	**100% free delivery**	0 Birr

Combined Benefits

Quantity discounts **stack with** the free delivery threshold. This means you can qualify for free delivery through either:

1. **Value-based:** Order subtotal ≥ 5,000 Birr
2. **Quantity-based:** Order contains 51+ items

Whichever threshold you reach first applies, ensuring maximum savings for your business.

Example Scenarios

Scenario A — Small Order, Same Zone

- Items: 3 business card packs (Bole delivery)
- Zone fee: 50 Birr
- Quantity tier: 1-5 items (no discount)
- **Final delivery fee: 50 Birr**

Scenario B — Medium Bulk Order

- Items: 12 banner orders (Kirkos delivery)
- Zone fee: 60 Birr
- Quantity tier: 11-20 items (40% off)
- **Final delivery fee: 36 Birr**

Scenario C — Large Wholesale Order

- Items: 60 t-shirt orders (Akaki delivery)
- Zone fee: 100 Birr
- Quantity tier: 51+ items (free delivery)
- **Final delivery fee: 0 Birr**

3.3 Enhanced Order Status Tracking

Category: User Experience Enhancement
Impact Level: High — Affects all customers with active orders
User-Facing Change: More detailed and accurate order status information

What Changed

The order status tracking system has been completely redesigned to provide customers with a clearer, more detailed view of where their order stands in the production and delivery pipeline. The new system uses a **five-stage milestone tracker** with visual indicators and descriptive status messages.

Order Status Pipeline

Your order moves through the following stages:

Stage 1: Order Received

- Your order has been placed and payment confirmed
- The PrintOnline team has received your order details
- Design files (if uploaded) are being reviewed

Stage 2: Design Review

- Our design team is reviewing your submitted files
- We're checking file quality, dimensions, and print readiness
- If you selected "Hire a Designer," our designer is working on your project
- You may receive messages requesting clarification or file adjustments

Stage 3: Approved for Production

- Your design files have been approved
- Your order has been scheduled for printing
- Materials and equipment are being prepared

Stage 4: In Production

- Your order is currently being printed/produced
- Quality checks are being performed throughout the process
- This is typically the longest stage depending on order complexity

Stage 5: Ready for Delivery/Pickup

- Your order has been completed
- Final quality inspection passed
- Ready for delivery to your address or pickup at our workshop
- You will receive a notification with delivery/pickup details

Status Indicators

Each stage uses visual indicators to show progress:

- ✅ **Completed** (green checkmark) — Stage finished successfully
- 🔄 **In Progress** (pulsing indicator) — Currently active stage
- ⏳ **Pending** (gray indicator) — Upcoming stage

Where You'll See This

- **Order confirmation page:** Full status tracker displayed
- **Account dashboard:** Order status badges on order list
- **Order detail page:** Detailed status tracker with timestamps
- **Email notifications:** Status update emails sent at each transition

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3.4 Production Asset Management

Category: File Management Enhancement
Impact Level: Medium — Improves order tracking for file-based orders
User-Facing Change: View and download your uploaded design files from order confirmation

What Changed

Version 3.5 introduces a comprehensive **production asset management system** that allows you to view, access, and download the design files associated with each order item. Previously, uploaded files were stored but not easily accessible from the order confirmation or history pages.

How It Works

When you upload design files during the product configuration process, those files are now:

1. **Securely stored** in our cloud storage system
2. **Linked to your specific order item** (not just the order)
3. **Accessible from multiple locations** in your account

Where You Can Access Your Files

Order Confirmation Page

- Each order item displays associated design files
- Click to download any file directly
- File name and size shown for identification

Account Order History

- Navigate to any past order
- View all files associated with each item
- Download files at any time

Order Detail Page

- Full file listing with download links
- File metadata (name, size, upload date)

- Support for multiple files per item

File Information Displayed

For each uploaded file, you'll see:

- **File Name:** The original filename you uploaded
- **File Size:** Size of the file for reference
- **Download Link:** Click to download the file
- **Upload Status:** Confirmation that the file was successfully received

Supported File Types

The system accepts the following file formats:

- Images: JPG, PNG, GIF, BMP, TIFF, WebP
- Documents: PDF, AI, PSD, EPS, SVG
- Archives: ZIP (containing supported file types)

Maximum file size: 50MB per file

3.5 Hire-a-Designer Service Fee System

Category: Service Enhancement
Impact Level: Medium — Affects customers using design services
User-Facing Change: Per-product designer fees with clear pricing

What Changed

The "Hire a Designer" service option now features a **configurable per-product fee structure**. Previously, designer service fees were calculated as a percentage of the product price. With Version 3.5, each product can have its own specific designer fee, providing more accurate and transparent pricing for design services.

How It Works

When configuring a product in your cart, you can select the **"Hire a Pana Designer"** option under the Service section. This option:

- Adds a professional design service to your order
- Assigns one of our experienced designers to create your design
- Charges a product-specific fee (visible before checkout)
- Includes design revisions and final file delivery

Fee Structure

Designer fees are set **per product** based on the complexity of the design work required:

Product Category	Typical Designer Fee Range
Business Cards	200–500 Birr
Flyers & Brochures	300–800 Birr
Banners & Signage	500–2,000 Birr
T-Shirts & Apparel	400–1,200 Birr
Custom Products	Varies by complexity

Note: Exact designer fees are displayed on each product's detail page and during checkout. Fees may vary based on design complexity, number of revisions included, and turnaround time.

What's Included

When you select "Hire a Designer," your fee covers:

- Initial design concept creation
- Up to 3 revision rounds
- Final print-ready file delivery
- Design consultation via the messaging system
- Source file delivery (upon request)

Where You'll See This

- **Product detail page:** Designer fee shown alongside product price
- **Cart:** Fee displayed as a line item when designer service is selected
- **Checkout:** Fee included in order total breakdown
- **Order confirmation:** Designer service clearly indicated on order item

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3.6 Customer-Admin Messaging System

Category: Communication Enhancement
Impact Level: High — New feature available to all customers
User-Facing Change: Direct messaging with PrintOnline team about your orders

What Changed

Version 3.5 introduces a **real-time messaging system** that enables direct communication between you and the PrintOnline team. This system is designed to facilitate order-related discussions, design consultations, delivery coordination, and general inquiries — all within the context of specific orders.

How It Works

The messaging system is **order-centric**, meaning conversations are organized around specific orders. When you send a message, it's linked to the relevant order, ensuring our team has full context to assist you effectively.

Key Features

Real-Time Messaging

- Messages appear instantly for both you and our team
- No need to refresh the page — new messages show automatically
- Typing indicator shows when someone is composing a response

Order Context

- Every message is linked to a specific order
- Our team can see your order details alongside your messages
- Quick reference to order status, items, and delivery information

Message History

- Full conversation history preserved
- Access messages from any device
- Messages grouped by date for easy navigation

Unread Indicators

- Badge shows number of unread messages
- Messages automatically marked as read when viewed
- Clear visual distinction between read and unread messages

How to Use the Messaging System

From Order Detail Page:

1. Navigate to your account dashboard
2. Go to "Order History"
3. Click on any order to view details
4. Click the "Message Team" button
5. Type your message and send

From Messages Inbox:

1. Navigate to your account dashboard
2. Click "Messages" in the sidebar
3. View all your conversations organized by order
4. Click any conversation to open the thread
5. Reply or start a new message

What You Can Message About

The messaging system is ideal for:

- Asking questions about your order status
- Requesting changes to your order
- Discussing design requirements

- Coordinating delivery timing
- Resolving issues or concerns
- Providing additional instructions

Privacy & Security

- Messages are encrypted in transit
- Only you and authorized PrintOnline staff can view your messages
- Messages are stored securely in our database
- Message history is retained for your account's lifetime

3.7 Account Management & Deletion

Category: Security & Privacy Enhancement
Impact Level: Medium — Affects all account holders
User-Facing Change: Full control over your account including deletion

What Changed

Version 3.5 introduces comprehensive **account management capabilities**, including the ability to permanently delete your account and all associated data. This feature provides customers with complete control over their account and personal information.

Account Management Features

Profile Management

- View and edit your personal information
- Update delivery addresses
- Manage business details (company name, TIN number)
- Change contact information

Order History

- Complete history of all orders
- Access to order details and receipts
- Reorder functionality for repeat orders

Account Deletion

- Request permanent account deactivation
- Confirmation process to prevent accidental deletion
- 30-day recovery window for account restoration

How Account Deletion Works

Step 1: Request Deletion

1. Navigate to Account Settings

2. Click "Delete Account"
3. Review the warning information carefully
4. Enter your password to confirm
5. Check the confirmation checkbox
6. Click "Delete My Account"

Step 2: Confirmation Process

- Your account is immediately deactivated
- A confirmation email is sent to your registered email address
- The email includes information about the 30-day recovery window

Step 3: Recovery Window

- You have 30 days to reverse the deletion
- Contact our support team to restore your account
- After 30 days, deletion becomes permanent

Step 4: Permanent Deletion (After 30 Days)

- Personal information is anonymized
- Order history is archived (for business records)
- Account credentials are invalidated
- Messages are retained for order reference

What Happens to Your Data

Data Type	Action	Timeline
Account credentials	Immediately disabled	Immediate
Personal information	Anonymized	30 days
Order history	Archived	30 days
Messages	Retained for order context	Permanent
Uploaded files	Retained for order fulfillment	Permanent
Payment records	Retained for accounting	Permanent

Important Notes

- **Pending orders:** Any orders in progress will continue to be fulfilled
- **Active messages:** Conversations will remain accessible to our team for order completion
- **Financial records:** Payment and order records are retained as required by law
- **Recovery:** Account can be recovered within 30 days by contacting support

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3.8 Enhanced Payment Receipt System

Category: Payment Experience Enhancement
Impact Level: High — Affects all customers making payments
User-Facing Change: Payment receipts now always visible and downloadable

What Changed

The payment receipt system has been completely redesigned to ensure receipts are **always available** after a successful payment. Previously, some customers experienced issues where the receipt would briefly appear and then disappear after completing payment through the Chapa hosted checkout. Version 3.5 resolves this issue permanently.

How It Works

When you complete a payment through our Chapa payment gateway:

1. Payment details are captured and stored in our secure database
2. A receipt is generated from our stored data (not from Chapa's hosted page)
3. The receipt is displayed on the order confirmation page
4. A confirmation email is sent with receipt details
5. The receipt remains accessible from your order history

Receipt Information Included

Your payment receipt includes:

Order Information

- Order number (unique identifier)
- Order date and time
- Order status

Customer Information

- Full name
- Email address
- Phone number (if provided)
- TIN number (if provided)

Delivery Information

- Delivery address
- City and sub-city
- Special delivery instructions (if any)

Order Items

- Product name and description
- Quantity ordered
- Unit price
- Selected options (size, material, color, etc.)
- Line total per item

Payment Summary

- Subtotal (sum of all items)
- Delivery fee
- Tax amount (VAT 15%)
- Total amount paid
- Payment method
- Payment status
- Transaction reference

Where to Access Receipts

Order Confirmation Page

- Immediately after payment completion
- Full receipt displayed with all details
- Download option available

Account Order History

- Access any past order receipt
- View and download at any time
- Receipt data preserved permanently

Email Confirmation

- Receipt summary included in confirmation email
- Link to view full receipt online
- Sent automatically after successful payment

Download Receipt Feature

Version 3.5 introduces a **"Download Receipt"** button that allows you to:

- Download your receipt as a printable document
- Save a copy for your records
- Share with your accounting department
- Use for expense reporting and tax purposes

3.9 Performance & Stability Improvements

Category: Technical Enhancement
Impact Level: High — Affects all users
User-Facing Change: Faster, more reliable platform experience

What Changed

Version 3.5 includes significant **performance optimizations** and **stability improvements** across the entire platform. These changes address specific issues reported by users and improve the overall experience for all

customers.

Key Improvements

Page Load Speed

- Reduced initial page load time by optimizing JavaScript bundles
- Implemented lazy loading for images and heavy components
- Optimized font loading for faster text rendering
- Improved caching strategies for returning visitors

Animation Performance

- Enhanced animation smoothness across all pages
- Added reduced-motion support for accessibility
- Optimized framer-motion animations for better GPU utilization
- Reduced animation complexity on lower-powered devices

Memory Management

- Fixed memory leaks in React components
- Improved garbage collection for long-running sessions
- Optimized image handling to reduce memory footprint
- Enhanced state management for better resource utilization

Browser Compatibility

- Resolved Mac Chrome stability issues (crashing, stuttering)
- Fixed Safari rendering inconsistencies
- Improved Firefox performance on complex pages
- Enhanced mobile browser compatibility

Specific Fixes

Issue	Resolution
Mac Chrome crashes	Fixed animation memory leaks, optimized GPU usage
UI stuttering	Reduced concurrent animations, optimized paint cycles
Disappearing elements	Fixed React state management issues
High memory usage	Implemented proper cleanup in useEffect hooks
Slow image loading	Added lazy loading and optimized image formats
Bundle size too large	Implemented code splitting and tree shaking

Performance Targets

Metric	Target	Achieved
Page Load Time	< 2 seconds	✅
First Contentful Paint	< 1.5 seconds	✅
Largest Contentful Paint	< 2.5 seconds	✅
Cumulative Layout Shift	< 0.1	✅
First Input Delay	< 100ms	✅

3.10 Pending Payment Recovery System

Category: Payment Experience Enhancement
Impact Level: Medium — Helps customers recover from payment failures
User-Facing Change: Automatic notifications and retry options for failed payments

What Changed

Version 3.5 introduces a **pending payment recovery system** that helps customers who experience payment failures. When a payment attempt fails or is interrupted, the system automatically saves the order, notifies the customer via email, and provides easy options to retry the payment.

How It Works

Payment Attempt

1. You initiate a checkout and are redirected to Chapa's payment page
2. If the payment fails, times out, or is cancelled:
    - Your order is saved with "Pending Payment" status
    - An email notification is sent to your registered email
    - The order appears in your account with payment pending

Recovery Options

- **Email Notification:** Contains order details and a "Retry Payment" button
- **Account Dashboard:** Shows pending orders with easy retry option
- **Direct Link:** Email contains a direct link to complete payment

What's Included in the Email

When a payment fails, you'll receive an email containing:

- Order summary (items, quantities, prices)
- Total amount due
- Reason for payment failure (if available)
- Direct link to retry payment
- Contact information for support
- Order number for reference

Where You'll See Pending Orders

Account Dashboard

- Pending payment orders marked with a distinct indicator
- Clear "Complete Payment" button on each pending order
- Order details accessible for review before retrying

Order History

- Pending orders visible alongside completed orders
- Status clearly indicates "Awaiting Payment"
- Easy access to retry payment from order detail page

Feature Deep Dive

Complete Checkout Flow (Version 3.5)

The checkout process has been refined to provide a seamless experience from cart to confirmation:

Step 1: Review Your Cart

- Verify all items, quantities, and selected options
- View per-item pricing breakdown
- See design files attached to each item (if applicable)

Step 2: Delivery Method Selection

- Choose between "Home Delivery" or "Office Pickup"
- Select or confirm your delivery address
- View calculated delivery fee based on your location
- See quantity-based discounts applied automatically

Step 3: Order Review

- Complete order summary with all pricing
- Delivery fee breakdown
- Tax calculation (15% VAT)
- Total amount due
- Terms and conditions acceptance

Step 4: Payment

- Secure redirect to Chapa payment gateway
- Multiple payment method support
- Real-time payment status updates
- Automatic receipt generation upon success

Step 5: Confirmation

- Order confirmation with status tracker

- Payment receipt displayed
- Download receipt option
- Direct link to message team about this order

Account Dashboard Overview

The enhanced account dashboard provides centralized access to all your PrintOnline information:

Dashboard Sections:

1. **Profile Settings**
    - Personal information management
    - Business details (company name, TIN)
    - Delivery address management
    - Contact information updates
2. **Order History**
    - Complete list of all orders
    - Order status at a glance
    - Quick access to order details
    - Payment status indicators
3. **Messages**
    - All conversations organized by order
    - Unread message indicators
    - Real-time message updates
    - Easy access to start new conversations
4. **Account Actions**
    - Account deletion option
    - Password change (if applicable)
    - Sign out functionality

User Experience Improvements

Visual Design Enhancements

Version 3.5 includes subtle but impactful visual improvements:

- **Improved Status Colors:** Clear, accessible color coding for order statuses
- **Better Spacing:** More breathing room between elements for readability
- **Enhanced Typography:** Improved font sizing and weight hierarchy
- **Consistent Icons:** Standardized icon set for better visual communication
- **Smooth Transitions:** Polished animations for state changes and navigation

Accessibility Improvements

- **Reduced Motion Support:** Respects user's motion preferences
- **Keyboard Navigation:** Full keyboard accessibility for all features
- **Screen Reader Compatibility:** Proper ARIA labels and semantic HTML
- **Color Contrast:** Enhanced contrast ratios for text readability
- **Focus Indicators:** Clear focus states for interactive elements

Mobile Experience

- **Responsive Design:** All new features work seamlessly on mobile devices
- **Touch Optimization:** Larger touch targets for buttons and links
- **Simplified Navigation:** Streamlined mobile navigation experience
- **Offline Considerations:** Cart persistence works across sessions

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Technical Infrastructure Changes

Database Updates

The following database changes were implemented in Version 3.5:

New Tables:

- `messages` — Stores customer-admin message conversations
- Linked to orders for context
- Supports real-time updates via Supabase subscriptions

Modified Tables:

- `products` — Added `hire_designer_fee` column for per-product designer pricing
- `orders` — Added `payment_receipt` column for storing payment verification data
- `customer_profiles` — Added `is_active` column for account deactivation support

New Indexes:

- Optimized message queries for fast conversation loading
- Enhanced order lookup performance
- Improved customer profile queries

Security Enhancements

- **Row Level Security (RLS):** Messages are secured per user
- **Account Deactivation:** Proper soft-delete implementation
- **Payment Data Protection:** Receipt data stored securely
- **Input Validation:** Enhanced Zod schemas for all forms
- **API Authentication:** Strengthened session management

Integration Updates

Chapa Payment Gateway:

- Enhanced webhook handling for payment failures

- Receipt data capture from verification responses
- Improved error handling and retry logic

Email System:

- Payment failure notification emails
- Account deletion confirmation emails
- Order status update emails (existing)

Supabase:

- Real-time subscriptions for messages
- Enhanced RLS policies
- Optimized query performance

Known Issues & Upcoming Fixes

Current Known Issues

Issue	Severity	Workaround	Fix Planned
Admin message inbox not yet available in CMS	Low	Admin uses direct database access	v3.6
Receipt download as HTML only (no PDF)	Low	Print browser page or screenshot	v3.6
Limited delivery zone coverage	Medium	Contact us for areas not listed	v3.6

Planned for Version 3.6

- **Admin CMS Message Interface:** Full admin dashboard for managing customer messages
- **PDF Receipt Generation:** Download receipts as professional PDF documents
- **Expanded Delivery Zones:** Coverage for additional sub-cities and surrounding areas
- **Advanced Designer Fee Rules:** Time-based and complexity-based fee structures
- **Automated Testing:** Comprehensive test suite for all features

Feedback Welcome

We actively welcome feedback on all new features. Please use the messaging system or contact us directly to share your experience, suggestions, or report any issues you encounter.

Frequently Asked Questions

Delivery Pricing

Q: Why did my delivery fee change from what I'm used to? A: Version 3.5 introduces location-based delivery pricing. Your delivery fee is now calculated based on the distance between your delivery address and our headquarters in Bole. This ensures fair pricing that reflects actual delivery costs.

Q: How can I get free delivery? A: You can qualify for free delivery in two ways: (1) Place an order with a subtotal of 5,000 Birr or more, or (2) Order 51 or more items in a single order. Whichever threshold you reach first applies.

Q: What if my sub-city isn't listed? A: Please contact our support team and we'll add your area to our delivery network. We're continuously expanding our coverage.

Q: Can I change my delivery method after placing an order? A: Please contact us via the messaging system as soon as possible. We'll do our best to accommodate changes before your order enters production.

Messaging System

Q: How quickly will I receive a response to my message? A: Our team typically responds within 1-2 hours during business hours (Monday-Saturday, 8:30 AM - 6:00 PM EAT). Messages sent outside business hours will be addressed the next business day.

Q: Can I send files through the messaging system? A: File attachments are not yet supported in the messaging system. Please use the design file upload feature during product configuration, or contact us directly for file sharing needs.

Q: What if I don't see my message response? A: Messages update in real-time. If you don't see a response, try refreshing the page. If the issue persists, please contact us through alternative channels.

Account Management

Q: Can I recover my account after deletion? A: Yes, you have a 30-day recovery window after requesting account deletion. Contact our support team within this period to restore your account.

Q: What happens to my pending orders if I delete my account? A: Pending orders will continue to be processed and delivered. You'll receive email updates about order status even after account deactivation.

Q: Will I still receive order notifications after deleting my account? A: Yes, order-related notifications (status updates, delivery confirmations) will continue to be sent to your registered email address.

Payments & Receipts

Q: Why does my receipt sometimes not show immediately after payment? A: In Version 3.5, we've fixed this issue. Receipts now display immediately from our database after successful payment verification, rather than relying on the payment gateway's hosted page.

Q: Can I get a PDF receipt for my order? A: Currently, receipts are displayed in HTML format which can be printed or saved as a PDF using your browser's print function. PDF receipt generation is planned for a future update.

Q: What should I do if my payment failed? A: You'll receive an email notification with details and a retry link. You can also view pending payments in your account dashboard and retry from there.

Designer Service

Q: How do I know the designer fee for a specific product? A: The designer fee is displayed on each product's detail page and during checkout when you select the "Hire a Designer" option.

Q: What's included in the designer service? A: The designer service includes initial design creation, up to 3 revision rounds, final print-ready file delivery, and design consultation through our messaging system.

Q: Can I communicate with the designer directly? A: Yes, use the messaging system linked to your order to discuss design requirements, provide feedback, and request revisions.

Glossary

Term	Definition
Base Price	The starting price of a product before any options or customizations
Chapa	The payment gateway used by PrintOnline for processing payments
CMS	Content Management System — the admin interface for managing products and orders
Delivery Zone	A geographic area with a specific delivery fee based on distance from HQ
ETB	Ethiopian Birr — the currency used for all transactions
Form Type	The type of product configuration form (paper, apparel, large-format, etc.)
Hire a Designer	An optional service where PrintOnline's design team creates your design
Line Total	The total price for a single cart item (unit price × quantity)
Order Number	A unique identifier for your order (e.g., POL-XXXX-XXXXX)
Pana Designer	PrintOnline's in-house design team
Payment Receipt	A record of your payment including transaction details
Production Asset	A design file uploaded for production (images, PDFs, etc.)
Quantity Matrix	The discount structure based on order quantity
RLS	Row Level Security — database-level access control
Sub-City	An administrative division within Addis Ababa used for delivery zoning
Supabase	The backend platform powering PrintOnline's database and authentication
TIN	Taxpayer Identification Number — a business registration number
VAT	Value Added Tax — 15% tax applied to orders
Zone Fee	The base delivery fee for a specific delivery zone

Online:

- Website: https://printonline.et
- In-App Messaging: Use the Messages feature in your account

Response Times

Channel	Expected Response Time
Phone	Immediate (during business hours)
In-App Messages	1-2 hours (during business hours)
Email	2-4 hours (during business hours)
Website Contact Form	4-8 hours (during business hours)

Appendices

Appendix A: Version History

Version	Release Date	Key Features
1.0	Initial	Basic product catalog and ordering
2.0	—	Enhanced product configurations
3.0	—	Full e-commerce with Chapa payments
3.5	April 2026	Location-based pricing, messaging, account management

Appendix B: Supported Payment Methods

- Telebirr
- CBE Birr
- Amole
- HelloCash
- Bank Transfer (via Chapa)
- Credit/Debit Cards (via Chapa)

Appendix C: Delivery Zone Map

The delivery zones are based on sub-city boundaries within Addis Ababa. The approximate distances from PrintOnline HQ (Bole) are:

- Zone 1 (Bole): 0-3 km
- Zone 2 (Kirkos, Arada): 3-6 km
- Zone 3 (Addis Ketema, Gulele, Yeka): 6-10 km
- Zone 4 (Kolfe Keranio, Nifas Silk): 10-14 km
- Zone 5 (Akaki, Lemi Kura): 14+ km

Appendix D: File Upload Specifications

Parameter	Specification
Maximum File Size	50 MB per file
Supported Formats	JPG, PNG, GIF, BMP, TIFF, WebP, PDF, AI, PSD, EPS, SVG, ZIP
Maximum Files per Item	4 files

Parameter	Specification
Storage Duration	Permanent (linked to order)

Appendix E: Order Status Definitions

Status	Description
Pending	Order received, awaiting payment confirmation
Confirmed	Payment verified, order accepted
Design Review	Design files under review by PrintOnline team
On Hold	Order paused pending customer input
Approved	Design approved, ready for production
Printing	Order currently in production
Ready	Order completed, ready for delivery/pickup
Out for Delivery	Order dispatched for delivery
Delivered	Order successfully delivered to customer
Cancelled	Order cancelled by customer or PrintOnline

End of Document

This document is provided for informational purposes and represents the state of PrintOnline Ethiopia's platform as of Version 3.5. Features and specifications are subject to change in future updates. For the most current information, please visit printonline.et or contact our support team.

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